

Self Portrait against Red Wallpaper.

Close the blinds and kill the birds, I surrender
my desire for a logical culmination. I surrender my
desire to be healed. The blurriness of being alive.
Take it or leave it, and for the most part you take it.
Not just the idea of it but the ramifications of it.
People love to hate themselves, avoiding the
necessary recalibrations. Shame comes from vanity.
Shame means you're guilty, like the rest of us,
but you think you're better than we are. Maybe you
are. What would a better me paint? There is no
new me, there is no old me, there's just me, the same
me, the whole time. Vanity, vanity, forcing your
will on the world. Don't try to make a stronger wind,
you'll wear yourself out. Build a better sail. You
want to solve something? Get out of your own way.
What's the difference between me and the world?
Compartmentalization. The world doesn't know
what to do with my love. Because it isn't used to
being loved. It's a framework problem. Disheartening?
Obviously. I hope it's love. I'm trying really hard
to make it love. I said no more severity. I said it severely
and slept through all my appointments. I clawed

my way into the light but the light is just as scary.

I'd rather quit. I'd rather be sad. It's too much work.

Admirable? Not really. I hate my friends. And when

I hate my friends I've failed myself, failed to share

my compassion. I shine a light on them of my own

making: septic, ugly, the wrong yellow. I mean, maybe

it's better if my opponent wins.